



◁ North American F-100D
Super Sabre 1956

Origin USA

Engine 16,000 lb (7,257 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney J-57 turbojet

Top speed 864 mph (1,390 km/h)

Nicknamed the "Hun," the F-100 was the first of the USAF's "Century Series" fighters. Although highly advanced when introduced, the F-100C had a dangerous design flaw—the fin was too small. This was rectified in the D model seen here. Designed as a fighter, most F-100Ds were used as fighter-bombers in Vietnam.



△ North American F-100F
Super Sabre 1957

Origin USA

Engine 16,000 lb (7,257 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney J-57 turbojet

Top speed 864 mph (1,390 km/h)

Originally intended as a two-seat trainer, the F-100F saw extensive combat in Vietnam, where it was used as a "Fast FAC" (Forward Air Controller). The most notable difference in the F model was that its internal armament was reduced from four to two 20-mm cannon.



△ McDonnell F-101 Voodoo 1957

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 16,900 lb (7,666 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney J-57 turbojet

Top speed 1,134 mph (1,825 km/h)

Originally designed as a single-seater, later Voodoos had a two-crew cockpit and could be armed with nuclear missiles. Although very fast, the slow-speed handling was poor, with unsatisfactory characteristics such as a tendency to "pitch-up" at the stall. This was never fully rectified.



△ Vought (F-8E) F8U-1 Crusader 1957

Origin USA

Engine 16,200 lb (7,348 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney J-57 turbojet

Top speed 1,225 mph (1,975 km/h)

Unusual in that it had a variable-incidence wing to reduce takeoff and landing speeds, the F-8 Crusader was the US Navy's principal fleet defense fighter of the late 1950s. This French F-8E is shown with the wing pivoted upward.



△ Republic F-105D
Thunderchief 1958

Origin USA

Engine 24,500 lb (11,113 kg) thrust
Pratt & Whitney J-75 turbojet

Top speed 1,372 mph (2,208 km/h)

Often referred to as the "Thud," the Thunderchief is the largest single-seat, single-engine fighter ever made. Capable of flying supersonic at sea level, and Mach 2 at altitude, it bore the brunt of the fighting in the first half of the Vietnam War.

▷ Lockheed F-104G Starfighter 1958

Origin USA

Engine 16,500 lb (7,484 kg) thrust
General Electric J-79 turbojet

Top speed 1,328 mph (2,125 km/h)

The aircraft was known as "the missile with a man in it." The Starfighter was the first fighter capable of sustained flight at speeds in excess of Mach 2.

